



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*katham ca patate janturyātyate ca katham tathā |
kiyatā caiva kālena narakātsa vimucyate |
muktaścottiṣṭhate kena katham samtarate punaḥ || 60 ||
etatsarvamaśeṣeṇa vistareṇa yathātatham |
kathayadhvaṃ mahāprajñāḥ paraṃ kautūhalaṃ hi me || 61 ||
tamupendrapitāmaheśvareśappravareśaṃ viditārthatattvakośam |
duritāṅkitapāpayuktayogaṃ pratiyogaṃ tvidamāhuragrayogaṃ || 62 ||*

— Skandapurāṇa, Chapter 36, Verses 60-62

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

These verses from the Skandapurāṇa delve into the profound questions of suffering, karmic consequence, and liberation. Imagine yourself as the listener, filled with a deep longing to understand the cycle of life, death, and rebirth. You are essentially asking: How does a being fall into suffering? How are they tormented? How long does this torment last? And once freed, how do they rise again and cross over the ocean of samsara?

The verses reveal a profound yearning for knowledge, a “paraṃ kautūhalaṃ,” or supreme curiosity. This curiosity isn’t just idle; it’s a driving force pushing one toward spiritual understanding. The speaker seeks a detailed and accurate explanation, a complete understanding of the process.

Verse 62 then points to the source of this wisdom, describing someone akin to a master, a knower of the ultimate truth. This individual is likened to a reservoir of knowledge, someone who understands the subtle nuances of reality. They are capable of analyzing the complex interplay between sin, karma, and yoga, and how these influence your journey. This master is not simply relaying information but guiding you towards the highest form of yoga, a path that directly addresses and dissolves the suffering caused by past actions.

In today’s world, these questions remain incredibly relevant. We witness suffering all around us, both within ourselves and in the lives of others. Understanding the karmic roots of this suffering, the mechanisms that perpetuate it, and the pathways to liberation is crucial for navigating the complexities of modern life. The Skandapurāṇa reminds you that liberation isn’t a passive process; it requires active engagement with your karma, a willingness to purify your actions, and the guidance of a wise teacher. It encourages you to seek out that inner teacher, that wellspring of wisdom within yourself, and to cultivate practices that lead to lasting freedom.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

If suffering arises from past actions, what small, conscious changes can you make today to sow seeds of future peace and well-being?